

Joomla Article Workflow

Email Notification System

Workflow Documentation

1. Workflow Overview

The Article Approval Workflow is a structured multi-stage content pipeline implemented in Joomla CMS. It governs how articles are created, reviewed, edited, and finally published or rejected. The workflow operates exclusively within the "Workflow Articles" category and involves three key roles: Author, Editor, and Publisher.

The workflow is named: Article Approval Workflow

Applied to category: Workflow Articles

Automated email notifications are dispatched at every stage transition, ensuring all relevant parties are informed in real time without any manual communication.

2. Roles Involved

Three distinct roles participate in this workflow, each with defined responsibilities:

Role	Responsibilities	Key Permission
Author	Creates new articles; submits for review	Create
Editor	Reviews and edits articles submitted by authors	Edit
Publisher	Approves articles after editor review	Edit, Edit State, Publish

3. Workflow Stages

The workflow consists of five stages that an article passes through. Each stage represents the current state of the article in the editorial process.

Stage	Description	Responsible Role
1. Draft	The article is created by the Author and saved initially. It is not yet visible for review. This is the entry point of every article into the workflow.	Author
2. Review	The article has been submitted by the Author and is now awaiting review by the Editor. The Editor is notified via email to begin their review.	Editor
3. Edited	The Editor has reviewed and made necessary changes to the article. The article is now ready for the Publisher to make a final decision. The Publisher is notified via email.	Publisher
4. Published	The Publisher has approved the article. It is now live and publicly visible on the website.	Publisher

4. Workflow Transitions

Transitions define how an article moves from one stage to the next. Each transition is triggered by a specific role, and an automated email is sent to notify the next party in the process.

Transition	From Stage	To Stage	Triggered By	Email Sent To
Submit Article	Draft	Review	Author	Editor
Edit Article	Review	Edited	Editor	Publisher
Publish Article	Edited	Published	Publisher	

5. Detailed Workflow by Role

5.1 Author Workflow

The Author is the starting point of every article in this workflow.

1. Author logs into Joomla and creates a new article inside the "Workflow Articles" category.
2. The article is automatically saved in the Draft stage upon creation.
3. The Author triggers the Submit Article transition, which moves the article from Draft to Review.
4. The plugin sends an automated email to the Editor group notifying them of the new article.

Email sent to Editor contains:

- Article Title
- Article ID
- Author Name
- Direct link to the article

5.2 Editor Workflow

The Editor acts as the quality reviewer of the submitted article.

5. Editor receives the email notification and opens the article from the provided link.
6. Editor reviews the article content and makes necessary edits and improvements.
7. Upon saving the edited article, the Edit Article transition triggers and the article moves to the Edited stage.
8. The plugin automatically sends an email to the Publisher group notifying them the article is ready for approval.

Important: This notification is triggered every time the Editor edits the article, not just the first time.

Email sent to Publisher contains:

- Article Title
- Article ID
- Editor Name
- Direct link to review the article

5.3 Publisher Workflow

The Publisher makes the final decision on whether an article is approved for publication .

9. Publisher receives the email notification and opens the article for final review.
10. Publisher reads the article and decides to either Publish

Option 1 – Publish Article

- Publisher selects the Publish Article transition.
- Article moves to the Published stage and becomes publicly visible.

6. Email Notification Summary

The custom plugin (Content - Email Notify) handles all automated email notifications. It listens to the onContentAfterSave event, which fires each time an article is created or updated.

Trigger Event	Sent By	Recipient(s)	Email Contains
Author submits article	System (Plugin)	Editor Group	Title, ID, Author Name, Link
Editor edits article	System (Plugin)	Publisher Group	Title, ID, Editor Name, Review Link
